

Terrorism is a global phenomenon that is vaguely defines as sub-national acts of violence. It is generally meant to incite fear among a society through large scale acts of violence, often to innocent individuals (FBI 2025). The Tableau dashboard *Terrorism Around the World* visualizes various aspects of global terrorism. Namely, three diagrams utilizing the Global Terrorism Database collected by Miller et al. in 2020. The first diagram is a packed bubble chart that summarizes the number of terrorist attacks in each unique province or state over recorded time span from 1970 to 2020. The second, a proportional area chart, shows how the amount each region composed of total terrorist attacks over time changes. The third, a stacked bar chart, breaks down the distribution of attack types in each region. Together, they reveal the underlying complexities of terrorism- how, where and when they occur.

The packed bubble chart is a representation of the relationship between provinces and states and occurrences of terrorist attacks. Namely, that some provinces or states have an exceeding number of attacks, which is represented by the size of the circles. Some hotbeds of attacks such as Baghdad, Sindh and Northern Ireland, have been related by significant policymakers and economists as being caused by poverty and lack of job opportunities (Bush 2002) (Krueger 2001). This is linked to the opportunity cost theory of crime: more income made by individuals is more to lose from death or imprisonment linked to terrorism. However, quantitative analysis suggests otherwise. Terrorism was conducted by a span of individuals with varying levels of education and income and did not necessarily increase during times of economic struggle (Green, Glaser, and Rich 1998).

The proportional area chart describes the proportion of terrorist attacks that occurred in each region. It reveals the regional density of terrorism, or how terrorism attacks occurred more in specific regions in response to specific events. Note that spikes in instances of terrorism were

followed by falling figures. Spikes of note include western Europe, driven in large part by the Irish independence movement, and the Middle East, driven by a rise in Islamic Fundamentalism. Whereas the former was resolved via diplomatic solutions, which the chart shows as drastically effective, the latter was confronted through the War on Terror, which may have been effective: a given country was upwards of 60% more likely to experience a terrorism incident prior to or during the year 2001 than after (Smith and Zeigler 2017).

The stacked bar chart breaks down the type of terrorist attacks common to different regions. For all regions, bombing is most common, generally followed by armed assault or infrastructure attacks. These are chosen for their maximal effect of terror, driving all productive members of society to develop fear for becoming the next target, hampering productivity to drive political change. Some acts of terror may have been successful. Although in the short term, bombings may not have a significant effect on human productivity, in the long term it led to an overreaction towards immigration, arousal-anxiety from stimuli of the event for a large population, and general fear in the daily lives of residents (Silver 2002). Therefore, it truly depends on the actual goals of the terrorist to determine if the operation has any actual effectiveness.

Specific to the state of Florida, the final visualization is a density map showing the exact locations in which terrorism occurs. It is of note that most terrorist attacks occur near large metropolitan areas, as signified by larger circles in the area. Large areas are often denser, offering opportunities to conduct significant amounts of damage. Furthermore, they are often more politically progressive, which leads to controversy that drives individuals to violence. For example, the reasonably dense city of Oakland park experienced a firebombing in 2000. The firebombing was towards an abortion clinic but lead to no deaths and therefore no long-term effects on practices of abortion in the state (Sun Sentinel 2000) (Florida Agency for Health Care

Administration 2025). In the context of Apuzzo's 2016 analysis, community-based intervention and conversation may have prevented this arson, which was conducted in a way where harm to individuals was not possible and rather only acted as an expression of anger. This highlights the importance of community investment and dialogue to prevent terrorism.

In conclusion, occupation and income does not affect one's tendency to terrorism, while diplomacy and warfare may have each been effective solutions. Florida's existence of terrorism was most common in urban areas and are ideologically driven. Possibly through community intervention, these could also be mitigated and prevented.

Bibliography

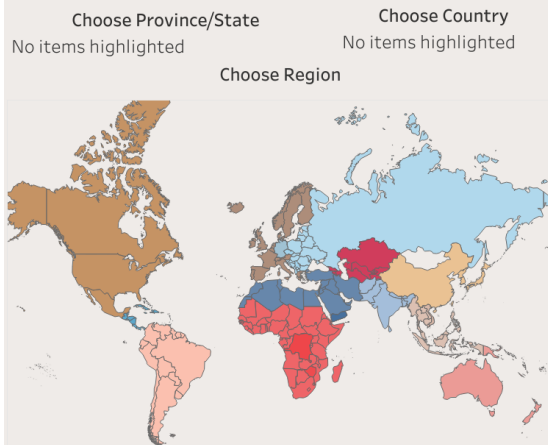
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Appendix:

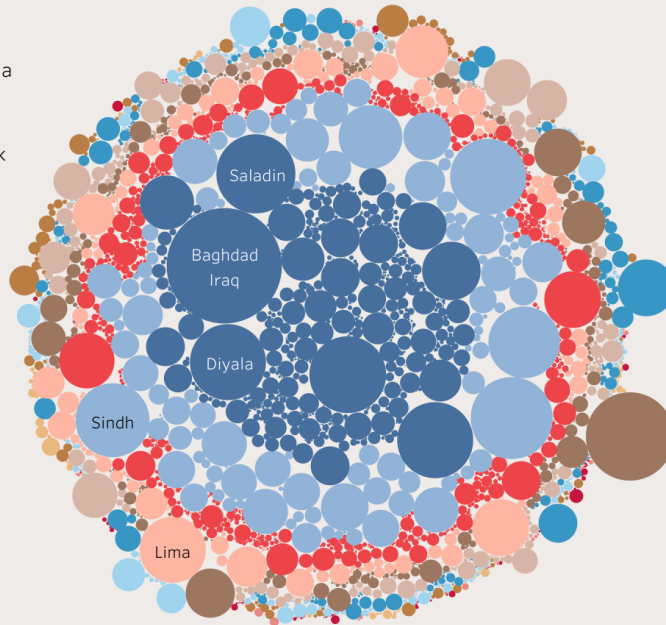
Terrorism Around the World

Terrorism is the use of violence by sub-national actors to spark fear. It is a global phenomenon that gained exceptional attention due to the 9/11 Attacks during 2001.

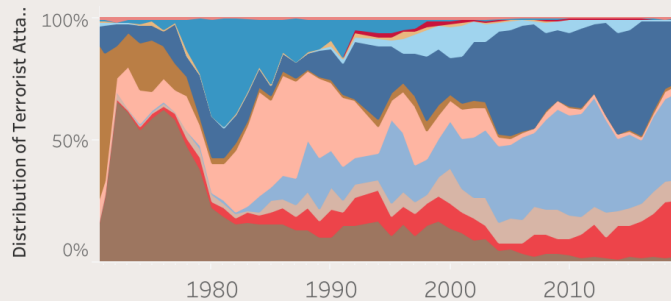
This dashboard visualizes various trends in terrorist attacks, with a **packed bubble chart** summarizing the number of terrorist attacks in province/state over the studied time span, a **proportional area chart** showing how the proportion of crime occurring in each region has changed over time, as well as a **stacked bar chart** which breaks down the distribution of attack types in each region. Together, they show how trends in terrorism has changed over time from 1970 to 2020.



Total Attacks by Region



Regional Proportion of Incidents Over Time



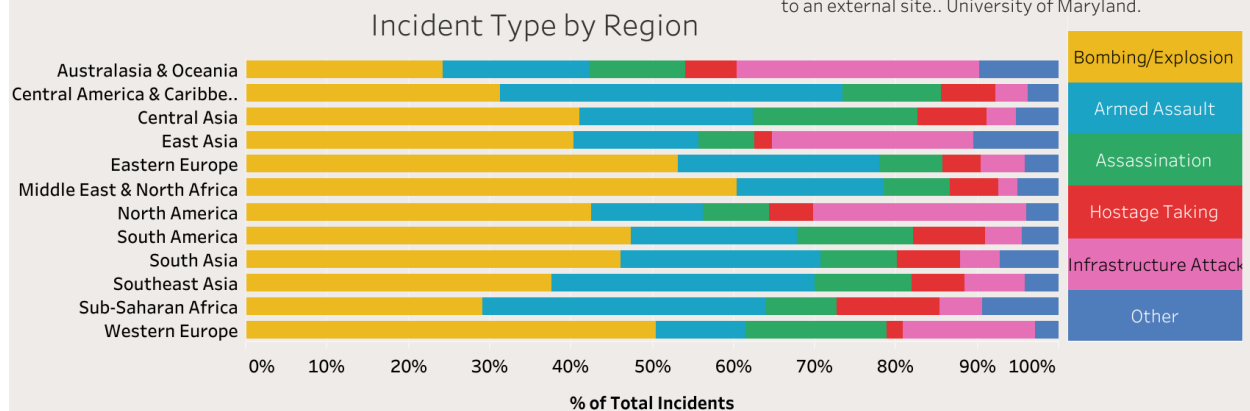
For above, note that each bubble represents a province or state, with its color represented by its region- matched to the world map legend to the left. Hover over for details regarding the number of attacks in the area.

To the left, the height of each color represents the proportion of all terrorist attacks occurred in the color's corresponding region in a specific year.

Below, the stacked bar chart further breaks down the types of attacks common in the region. Use the legend to the right of the bar chart to highlight one specific type of attack for analysis.

Data From:

Miller, E., LaFree, G. and Dugan, L. (2020). Study of Terrorism and Responses to Terrorism: Global Terrorism Database Links to an external site.. University of Maryland.



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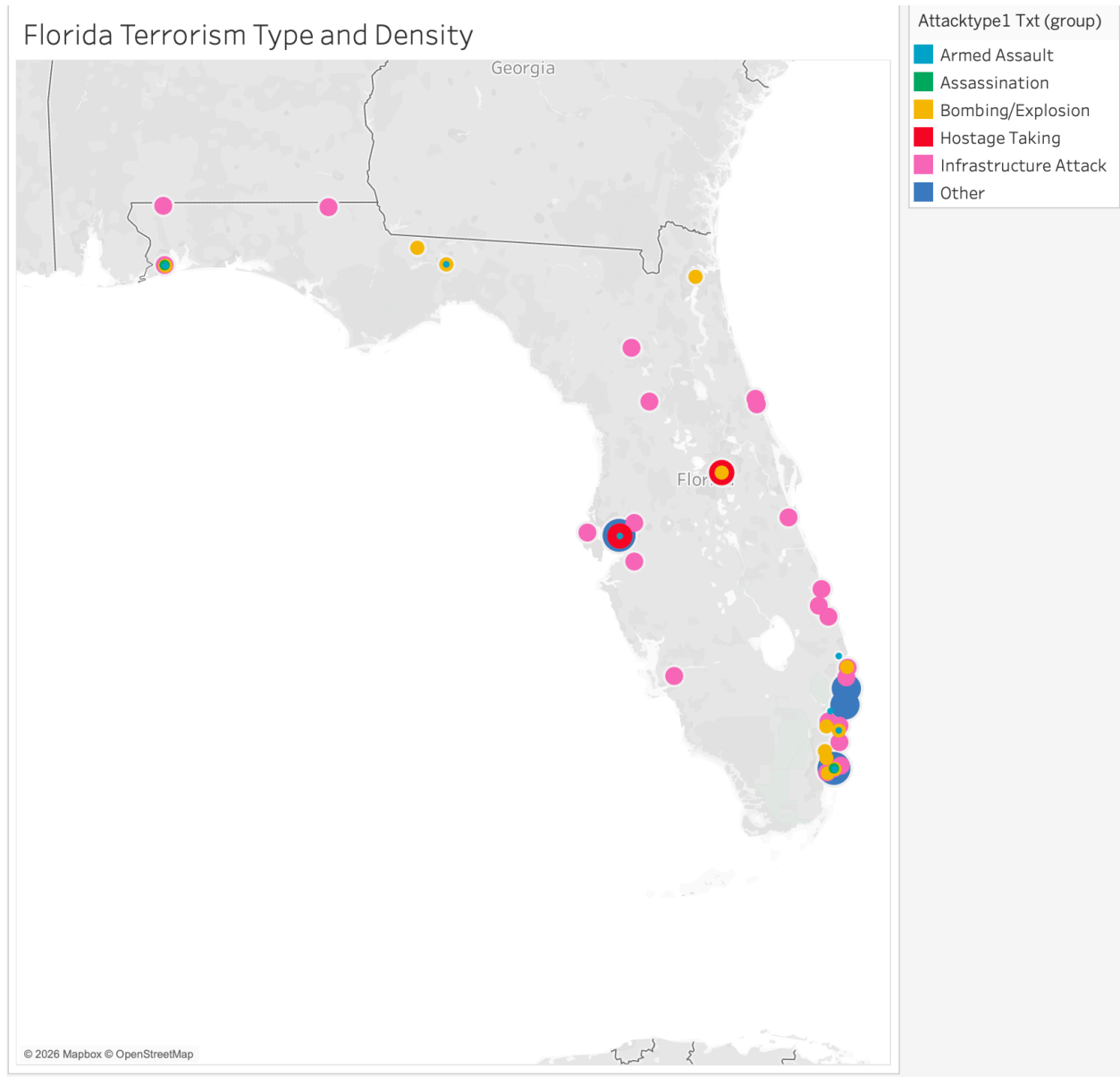


Figure 1 Write-up Visualization

Author's Statement:

No AI was used in this project.